

BANNER, BETTY

The Hulk's beloved

BETTY BANNER

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Elizabeth Ross Banner

OCCUPATION

None

BASE

Mobile

HEIGHT 5 ft 6 in

WEIGHT 110 lbs

EYES Blue

HAIR Brown

FIRST APPEARANCE

Incredible Hulk #1

(May 1962)

POWERS

No superhuman powers, but courageous and resourceful; steadfastly loyal to her husband Bruce Banner through many shared tribulations.

ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

• *Hulk Vol. 2* #168-169

MODOK transforms Betty into the Harpy.

• *Hulk Vol. 2* #319

After years of courtship and chaos, Bruce Banner finally marries Betty.

• *Hulk Vol. 2* #465-469

Betty is exposed to radiation poisoning. Bruce desperately tries to save her.

The only daughter of renowned military general Thaddeus "Thunderbolt" Ross, Betty spent her formative years firmly under her father's thumb. Thunderbolt Ross had wanted a son, and had no use for his unfortunate daughter; after her mother died during Betty's teenage years, she was sent away to boarding school. After graduating, she returned to her father's side, a repressed wallflower. Thunderbolt Ross was then in charge of a top-secret project to create a new type of weapon employing the limitless power of gamma radiation. The head scientist on the project was the quiet, bookish Bruce Banner, and an attraction between Betty and Banner soon developed.

TRAGIC LOVE

Their relationship was forever changed when, during the gamma-bomb test, Banner was struck by the full force of the detonation, and its radiations transformed him into the HULK whenever he grew angry. Banner tried to keep his condition secret from Betty, which only served to alienate them. Betty was then ardently pursued by Major Glenn Talbot (see TALBOT, COL. GLENN), the new aide attached to her father's Hulkbuster task force. Eventually, the secret of Banner's dual identity became public knowledge, and his transformations and rampages created a rift between Betty and himself. With no one else to turn to, Betty married Major Talbot. Their union soon ended in divorce, however, and Talbot died attempting to destroy the Hulk.

HARPY HORROR

Betty continued to find herself entangled in the lives of Bruce Banner and the Hulk. At one point she was transformed by the villainous MODOK into a gamma-empowered flying menace known as the Harpy. But even these trials could not destroy her love for hapless Bruce Banner, and eventually, despite her father's objections, she married him.

However lasting happiness was not to be theirs. The ABOMINATION used his own gamma-irradiated blood to poison Betty, hoping to pin the crime on Bruce. Later, the LEADER seemed to revive Betty, who then aided her fugitive husband as his shadowy contact Mr. Blue.

However, NIGHTMARE then revealed that her apparent return was only one of many hallucinations he'd used to manipulate the Hulk. Betty truly is dead.

TB, MF



Betty Banner met her one-day husband Bruce when she came to live on a New Mexico military base with her father, Thunderbolt Ross.



Bruce Banner's transformation into the rampaging Hulk has brought Betty a lot of strife, yet she remains devoted to her husband.

